

BM3 — Lesson 4: Joseph of Arimathea

Trust the Process



Theme: Obedience in the Quiet Moments



Background Text : Matthew 27:57–61; John 19:38–42



Key Verse: John 19:38 (WEB)

“After these things, Joseph of Arimathea, being a disciple of Jesus, but secretly for fear of the Jews, asked of Pilate that he might take away Jesus’ body. Pilate gave him permission. He came therefore and took away his body.”



Faith that honors Jesus even when the story looks finished.



Appetizer – Faith in Action, Matthew 27:57–58 (WEB)

“When evening had come, there came a rich man from Arimathea named Joseph, who himself was also Jesus’ disciple. This man went to Pilate, and asked for Jesus’ body. Then Pilate commanded the body to be given up.”

Joseph of Arimathea was a rich man, a respected council member, and a quiet follower of Jesus. When many had run away in fear, he stepped forward in love and courage. He went straight to Pilate and asked for the body of the crucified Christ—a bold, risky request that publicly tied his name to Jesus at the very moment things looked the worst.



CST Thought

Even in loss, faith moves us to act in honor. Joseph’s decision to claim Jesus’ body was not loud or flashy, but it was a quiet and powerful display of devotion when many others had fled.

Reflection Question

When have you had to act on your faith quietly but boldly, even when others were afraid to stand?

Main Course – The Pivot

Bite 1 Provision in Place, Matthew 27:59–60 (WEB)

“Joseph took the body, and wrapped it in a clean linen cloth, and laid it in his own new tomb, which he had cut out in the rock. Then he rolled a great stone to the door of the tomb, and departed.”

Joseph used what he had already prepared for himself—a new tomb carved in the rock—to honor Jesus. He wrapped the Lord’s body carefully, placed Him in that tomb, and sealed it with a great stone. What Joseph once thought was for his future became part of God’s bigger plan.

CST Thought

God’s provision is never late. Long before Jesus’ crucifixion, the Father had already chosen and prepared Joseph to meet this moment. What looked like a personal investment (a private tomb) became a kingdom assignment.

Author’s Commentary

It wasn’t just a believer who requested the body of Jesus, but Joseph of Arimathea—a wealthy man and quiet follower of Christ. He didn’t realize that the tomb he built for himself would one day hold the body of the Savior of the world. His influence and position on the council gave him access to Pilate, and because of that, the king granted his request for the body. God had already provided everything needed from Christ’s birth to His burial. All we must do is trust the process.

Sometimes the Lord will place you in a role, job, or position you don’t fully understand—not for your comfort, but for His assignment.

Reflection Question

Is there something God has called you to do that you don't yet understand? Are you willing to trust the process while your faith grows?

Bite 2 – Courage to Be Counted, John 19:38–40 (WEB)

“After these things, Joseph of Arimathaea, being a disciple of Jesus, but secretly for fear of the Jews, asked of Pilate that he might take away Jesus’ body. Pilate gave him permission. He came therefore and took away his body. Nicodemus, who at first came to Jesus by night, also came bringing a mixture of myrrh and aloes, about a hundred Roman pounds. So they took Jesus’ body, and bound it in linen cloths with the spices, as the custom of the Jews is to bury.”

Joseph had been a *secret* disciple, afraid of what the Jewish leaders might say. But at the cross, his secret faith became public action. Nicodemus, who once came to Jesus at night, joined him in this bold, costly act of honor. Both men stepped out of the shadows to align themselves with a “condemned” Messiah.

CST Thought

There comes a time when quiet belief must become visible obedience. Faith that stays hidden forever never fully walks in purpose. Joseph and Nicodemus show us that even if you started secretly, God can still call you to stand boldly.

Reflection Question

Where is God asking you to move from silent agreement to visible obedience?

Dessert – Faith Sealed in Stone, John 19:40–42 (WEB)

“So they took Jesus’ body, and bound it in linen cloths with the spices, as the custom of the Jews is to bury. Now in the place where he was crucified there was a garden. In the garden

was a new tomb in which no man had ever yet been laid. Then because of the Jews' Preparation Day (for the tomb was near at hand) they laid Jesus there."

Everything about this scene looked final: the spices, the linen, the new tomb, the stone. Yet heaven knew this was not the end—it was a setup. The garden tomb was not a permanent resting place; it was the stage for resurrection.

CST Thought

When you trust God's process, even what looks like a burial can become the birthplace of breakthrough. What we call "the end" may be where God is just getting started.

Reflection Question

What area of your life feels "sealed in stone" right now—and how might God be working behind the scenes in ways you cannot see yet?

To-Go Box

- Faith and foresight remind us that obedience opens doors long before we know we'll need to walk through them.
- God often uses our resources, positions, and plans for purposes bigger than we imagined.
- Trust that God's plans are already in motion—even when you can't see the full picture yet.
- Like Joseph of Arimathea, your quiet preparation today may be part of a major move of God tomorrow.

Closing Prayer

"Lord, thank You for Joseph of Arimathea's example of quiet, courageous faith. Help me to trust Your process, even when I don't understand every step. Use what I have and where I am for Your purpose, not just my plans. In Jesus' name, amen."

Personal Prayer Space

Write your own reflection or prayer to God about trusting His timing and His process in your life:

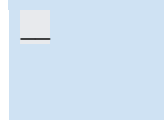
Word Study

- **Arimathea** – A town near Jerusalem; the name is associated with “heights” or a high place.
- **Joseph (Hebrew: *Yosef*)** – “He will add” or “He increases” — prophetic of increase and multiplication.
- **Trust (Hebrew: *Batach*)** – To rely on, be confident, or secure; a firm confidence in God’s provision and timing.

Write a short line about where you need to *batach*—to lean hard into trusting God’s process:

Activity – Connect the Process

Match each act of faith (left) with the result (right).

Match	Activity	Phrase
	1 Joseph's request for Jesus' body	A The burial fulfilled prophecy with reverence.
	2 Wrapping Jesus in linen	B A temporary seal that set up resurrection
	3 Building his own tomb	C Jesus' body was placed in a tomb of honor.
	4 Rolling the stone	D God used a personal plan for divine purpose

Reflection Thought (Activity Tie-In)

Faith builds what it may not yet understand, trusting that God will reveal its purpose in due time. Write a declaration that stretches your faith but is something you need/want/or hope the Lord will favor you to that end.



Appendix – Breakfast Month 3 (AE) Answer Key

Theme: Faith & Foresight – Youth Edition



Lesson 1 – Rahab: Faith That Took Action

 Activity – True or False: Rahab’s Faith

Lesson 1 – Rahab: Faith That Took Action

Activity – True or False

1. Rahab was an Israelite woman raised in a godly home.
➤ False – She was a Canaanite woman from Jericho.
 2. The scarlet rope was a sign of the agreement between Rahab and the spies.
➤ True
 3. Rahab’s actions showed both faith in God and concern for her family.
➤ True
 4. Rahab’s faith only affected her, not anyone else.
➤ False – Her whole household was saved.
 5. Rahab is later mentioned in the family line of Jesus.
➤ True – She appears in His genealogy.
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Lesson 2 – Abigail: Wisdom on the Move

Activity – Fill in the Blank

1. Abigail acted with wisdom and faith, not fear.
2. Nabal’s pride led to his death.
3. David praised God for Abigail’s good sense/wisdom.
4. Abigail’s wisdom prevented bloodshed/killing and brought peace.